

Wrong ASN.1! No cookie for you!

Microsoft has issued a warning to users running its Windows NT, Windows 2000, Windows XP or Windows Server 2003 operating systems. The warning encourages users to immedi-

each of which can hence be used as an entry-point into an unpatched system by a hacker. Exploiting the flaw is much easier if the attacker can access a local network, an advisory posted on Microsoft's Web site noted.



ately patch their systems, or risk malicious hacks through a security hole. If left unpatched, the hole could allow a worm to spread throughout the Internet in a manner similar to the MSBlast attack last year.

The flaw exists in Microsoft's implementation of a networking protocol known as Abstract Syntax Notation One (ASN.1). The code under consideration is shared by many Windows applications,

The fact translates into a large number of vulnerable systems and thus a good candidate for an Internet worm attack.

The flaw was first pointed out by the software firm, eEye Digital Security, and Microsoft issued a fix two hundred days later. Marc Maiffret, of the security firm termed the delay as ridiculous, while Microsoft's Toulouse said the fix took so long to create because of the difficulties posed by such a pervasive technology: "This is an instance where we really had to do our due diligence."

A dash ridiculous

Windows will now be known as Lin---s (pronounced as Lin-dash) in some European countries where Microsoft has blocked the availability of the desktop distribution.

"By removing three letters from our product name, Lin-dash.com will not be creating any confusion regarding Microsoft's supposed trademark on 'Windows', and still offer choice in the marketplace," said Lin-dash.com CEO, Michael Robertson. "Any action from Microsoft to block Lin---s will show their true intentions are not to protect their trademark, but to eliminate competition and maintain their monopoly." This step was taken by the company to comply with an Amsterdam court ruling. The company has also opened new Web sites—Lin---s.com and Lin-dash.nl—to support the same.

nVidia for Palm

PalmSource recently announced a partnership with nVidia. It will provide nVidia with Palm OS Garnet and Cobalt tools that will enable creation of drivers for the GeForce family of media processors, making them available to Palm OS licensees.

The GeForce 2150 media processor includes a 64-bit 2D graphics accelerator, embedded memory for LCD frame buffer and a 1.3 megapixel camera support. It also supports TFT and OLED technology, at up to a 320 x 480 resolution.

Earlier, PalmSource announced the release of Palm OS Garnet, while the Palm OS 5.x release has been renamed Cobalt.

redalert

W32.Netsky.B@mm

This mass-mailing worm only affects Windows 9x, Windows NT, Windows 2000 and Windows XP systems. It does not affect Windows 3.x, Macintosh, Linux and Unix systems. A built-in SMTP engine lets it propagate through all e-mail addresses obtained while scanning hard drives and mapped drives. It also infects files with extensions such as .TXT, .HTML, .DOC, .VBS and .DBX. It copies itself into the services directory and many other folders, makes registry changes and degrades system performance. Access its removal tool from <http://www.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.netsky.b@mm.removal.tool.html>

Real trouble

Recently, RealNetworks discovered that RealOne Player and RealPlayer were vulnerable to three specific exploits while executing RealPlayer files with the extensions .RP, .RT, .RAM, .RMP and .SMIL. These files render the user's system vulnerable to download and run any malicious code. The exploits include executing remote JavaScript from the domain of the URL opened by the malicious file, download and execute arbitrary code on the user's machine, and create buffer overrun errors. Download the fix from www.real.com.

statattack

When the Mars rovers Landed on the Red Planet



Source: NASA

Online Commerce



Source: VeriSign

INFOGRAPHICS: Sachin Dalvi

snapshot

60 per cent of all e-mails sent in **January 2004** were identified as **spam**

Source: Brightmail Logistics and Operations Center

■ Individuals counter sue RIAA under US government anti-racketeering laws ■ Windows now features support for Intel's mobile Centrino technology